

Of the Father's Love Begotten

- 1 Of the Father's love begotten
ere the worlds began to be,
he is Alpha and Omega,
he the Source, the Ending he,
of the things that are, that have been,
and that future years shall see,
evermore and evermore!
- 2 O that birth forever blessed,
when the Virgin, full of grace,
by the Holy Ghost conceiving,
bore the Savior of our race;
and the babe, the world's Redeemer,
first revealed his sacred face,
evermore and evermore!
- 3 This is he whom heav'n taught singers
sang of old with one accord,
whom the Scriptures of the prophets
promised in their faithful word;
now he shines, the long expected;
let creation praise its Lord,
evermore and evermore!
- 4 O ye heights of heav'n, adore him;
angel hosts, his praises sing;
pow'rs, dominions, bow before him
and extol our God and King;
let no tongue on earth be silent,
ev'ry voice in concert ring,
evermore and evermore!
- 5 Christ, to thee, with God the Father,
and, O Holy Ghost, to thee,
hymn, and chant, and high thanksgiving,
and unwearied praises be,
honor, glory, and dominion,
and eternal victory,
evermore and evermore!

Words: Aurelius Clemens Prudentius, 5th cent.; tr. John Mason Neale, 1854 and H. W. Baker, 1859

Music: Plainsong melody, 12th cent.; arr. Charles Winfred Douglas, 1916

Tune: DIVINUM MYSTERIUM · 8.7.8.7.8.7.7 · Scripture: John 1:1, 14

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